

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Lokpal and Lokayuktas - Solved Practice Workbook

Polity | GS-II | Solved practice workbook

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Workbook Contents

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Lokpal and Lokayuktas - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Polity | **GS Paper:** GS-II | **Control date:** 8 September 2026

Practice discipline: exactly 32 original MCQs before PYQs; answer order ABCD repeated eight times; 128 substantive option-specific explanations; 32 unique question-specific traps; one verified direct Prelims PYQ with official-key discipline; exactly six original Mains models.

Exactly **32 original MCQs** appear before the PYQ section. Correct-option sequence:

ABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCD. Questions 25-32 provide targeted remediation while remaining part of the same 32-question original set.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1. Legal identity

Which statement best describes the Lokpal?

A. It is a statutory anti-corruption ombudsman whose powers and limits arise from the 2013 Act. B. It is an executive body created only by a government resolution. C. It is the investigative division of the CVC. D. It is a constitutional court for corruption offences.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Section 3 establishes Lokpal under parliamentary legislation; sections 20 and 35 separate its process role from criminal adjudication.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It is an executive body created only by a government resolution.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 establishes Lokpal under parliamentary legislation; sections 20 and 35 separate its process role from criminal adjudication.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It is the investigative division of the CVC.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 establishes Lokpal under parliamentary legislation; sections 20 and 35 separate its process role from criminal adjudication.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It is a constitutional court for corruption offences.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 establishes Lokpal under parliamentary legislation; sections 20 and 35 separate its process role from criminal adjudication.

Examiner trap 1: Do not convert statutory status into either executive-resolution status or constitutional-court status.

MCQ 2. Composition ceiling

The Lokpal consists of:

A. A Chairperson and not more than ten Members. B. A Chairperson and not more than eight Members. C. A Chairperson and exactly eight Members. D. A Chairperson, eight Members and the CVC as an ex officio Member.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A Chairperson and not more than ten Members.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 fixes one Chairperson and a ceiling of eight Members; it neither guarantees all seats are filled nor adds the CVC.
- **B:** Correct. Section 3 fixes one Chairperson and a ceiling of eight Members; it neither guarantees all seats are filled nor adds the CVC.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A Chairperson and exactly eight Members.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 fixes one Chairperson and a ceiling of eight Members; it neither guarantees all seats are filled nor adds the CVC.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A Chairperson, eight Members and the CVC as an ex officio Member.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 fixes one Chairperson and a ceiling of eight Members; it neither guarantees all seats are filled nor adds the CVC.

Examiner trap 2: Read 'not exceeding' as a ceiling, not a mandatory filled strength.

MCQ 3. Percentage rules

Which composition statement is correct?

A. The representation rule applies only to non-judicial Members. B. Half of the whole institution, including the Chairperson, must be judicial. C. Fifty per cent of the Members shall be Judicial Members, and not less than fifty per cent of Members must satisfy the listed representation rule. D. At least half of the Members must be serving judges.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'The representation rule applies only to non-judicial Members.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 uses Members as the denominator for both the judicial share and the SC/ST/OBC/minority/women floor; the categories may overlap.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Half of the whole institution, including the Chairperson, must be judicial.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 uses Members as the denominator for both the judicial share and the SC/ST/OBC/minority/women floor; the categories may overlap.
- **C:** Correct. Section 3 uses Members as the denominator for both the judicial share and the SC/ST/OBC/minority/women floor; the categories may overlap.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'At least half of the Members must be serving judges.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 uses Members as the denominator for both the judicial share and the SC/ST/OBC/minority/women floor; the categories may overlap.

Examiner trap 3: UPSC may change the denominator, replace a floor with an exact quota, or require serving judges.

MCQ 4. Chairperson eligibility

Who may be appointed Chairperson under section 3?

A. Only a former Chief Justice of India. B. Only a Supreme Court Judge. C. Only a serving Chief Justice of India. D. A serving or former CJI, a serving or former Supreme Court Judge, or an eminent person satisfying the statutory expertise condition.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Only a former Chief Justice of India.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The Act provides judicial routes and an eminent-person route linked to the integrity, ability and expertise criteria for a non-judicial Member.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Only a Supreme Court Judge.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The Act provides judicial routes and an eminent-person route linked to the integrity, ability and expertise criteria for a non-judicial Member.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Only a serving Chief Justice of India.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The Act provides judicial routes and an eminent-person route linked to the integrity, ability and expertise criteria for a non-judicial Member.
- **D:** Correct. The Act provides judicial routes and an eminent-person route linked to the integrity, ability and expertise criteria for a non-judicial Member.

Examiner trap 4: The Chairperson's office is not reserved exclusively for a former CJI.

MCQ 5. Non-judicial expertise

A non-judicial Member must ordinarily possess:

- A. At least twenty-five years of special knowledge and expertise in the listed fields. B. Thirty years in any occupation.
C. Ten years of judicial office. D. Twenty years as a Member of Parliament.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Section 3 specifies at least 25 years in anti-corruption policy, public administration, vigilance, finance including insurance and banking, law or management.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Thirty years in any occupation.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 specifies at least 25 years in anti-corruption policy, public administration, vigilance, finance including insurance and banking, law or management.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Ten years of judicial office.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 specifies at least 25 years in anti-corruption policy, public administration, vigilance, finance including insurance and banking, law or management.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Twenty years as a Member of Parliament.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 3 specifies at least 25 years in anti-corruption policy, public administration, vigilance, finance including insurance and banking, law or management.

Examiner trap 5: Do not replace a listed-field expertise test with generic seniority.

MCQ 6. Disqualification

Which person is not expressly disqualified merely by the stated fact?

- A. A sitting Member of Parliament. B. A retired civil servant aged sixty who otherwise satisfies every statutory condition. C. A sitting member of a Municipality. D. A person removed or dismissed from Union or State service.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A sitting Member of Parliament.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Retirement from public service is not itself a bar; section 3(4) separately lists legislative office, local-body membership, removal/dismissal, age and incompatibilities.
- **B:** Correct. Retirement from public service is not itself a bar; section 3(4) separately lists legislative office, local-body membership, removal/dismissal, age and incompatibilities.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A sitting member of a Municipality.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Retirement from public service is not itself a bar; section 3(4) separately lists legislative office, local-body membership, removal/dismissal, age and incompatibilities.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A person removed or dismissed from Union or State service.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Retirement from public service is not itself a bar; section 3(4) separately lists legislative office, local-body membership, removal/dismissal, age and incompatibilities.

Examiner trap 6: Do not confuse prior public service with disqualifying removal from service.

MCQ 7. Selection Committee

The statutory Selection Committee for Lokpal appointments includes:

- A. President, Prime Minister, CJI, CVC and Attorney General. B. Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha Chairman, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI and CVC. C. Prime Minister, Lok Sabha Speaker, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominee, and an eminent jurist. D. Prime Minister, Home Minister, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI and Cabinet Secretary.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'President, Prime Minister, CJI, CVC and Attorney General.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4 names the Prime Minister as chair, Speaker, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominated Supreme Court judge, and one eminent jurist.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha Chairman, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI and CVC.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4 names the Prime Minister as chair, Speaker, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominated Supreme Court judge, and one eminent jurist.
- **C:** Correct. Section 4 names the Prime Minister as chair, Speaker, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominated Supreme Court judge, and one eminent jurist.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Prime Minister, Home Minister, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI and Cabinet Secretary.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4 names the Prime Minister as chair, Speaker, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominated Supreme Court judge, and one eminent jurist.

Examiner trap 7: A plausible office from the CVC or CBI appointment process is not automatically a Lokpal selector.

MCQ 8. Eminent jurist route

The eminent jurist on the Selection Committee is:

A. Nominated by the Chief Justice of India alone. B. Selected finally by the Search Committee. C. Elected by a joint sitting of Parliament. D. Nominated by the President on recommendation of the other four Selection Committee members.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Nominated by the Chief Justice of India alone.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(1)(e) assigns nomination to the President on the recommendation of the first four members of the Selection Committee.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Selected finally by the Search Committee.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(1)(e) assigns nomination to the President on the recommendation of the first four members of the Selection Committee.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Elected by a joint sitting of Parliament.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(1)(e) assigns nomination to the President on the recommendation of the first four members of the Selection Committee.
- **D:** Correct. Section 4(1)(e) assigns nomination to the President on the recommendation of the first four members of the Selection Committee.

Examiner trap 8: The President is the formal nominator, but the recommendation source is statutorily specified.

MCQ 9. Search Committee

Which statement about the Search Committee is correct?

A. It has at least seven experts, a statutory representation floor and prepares a panel that does not bind the Selection Committee exclusively. B. It makes the final appointment by warrant. C. It may consider only serving judges. D. It consists of exactly five constitutional office-holders.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Section 4(3) requires at least seven persons with listed expertise, a 50 per cent diversity floor, and permits selection beyond its recommended panel.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It makes the final appointment by warrant.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(3) requires at least seven persons with listed expertise, a 50 per cent diversity floor, and permits selection beyond its recommended panel.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It may consider only serving judges.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(3) requires at least seven persons with listed expertise, a 50 per cent diversity floor, and permits selection beyond its

recommended panel.

- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It consists of exactly five constitutional office-holders.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(3) requires at least seven persons with listed expertise, a 50 per cent diversity floor, and permits selection beyond its recommended panel.

Examiner trap 9: Search and selection are different stages; the Search Committee is neither appointing authority nor exclusive gatekeeper.

MCQ 10. Vacancy and Common Cause

Under section 4(2) and Common Cause v. Union of India (2017), which proposition is safest?

A. The Search Committee becomes the appointing authority whenever the LoP post is vacant. B. A vacancy does not by itself invalidate appointment proceedings, so implementation need not await a statutory amendment. C. Every appointment without a recognised LoP is automatically void. D. The Act permanently substitutes the leader of the largest opposition party for the LoP.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'The Search Committee becomes the appointing authority whenever the LoP post is vacant.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(2) validates action despite a Selection Committee vacancy, and Common Cause held the Act workable without waiting for proposed amendments.
- **B:** Correct. Section 4(2) validates action despite a Selection Committee vacancy, and Common Cause held the Act workable without waiting for proposed amendments.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Every appointment without a recognised LoP is automatically void.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(2) validates action despite a Selection Committee vacancy, and Common Cause held the Act workable without waiting for proposed amendments.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'The Act permanently substitutes the leader of the largest opposition party for the LoP.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 4(2) validates action despite a Selection Committee vacancy, and Common Cause held the Act workable without waiting for proposed amendments.

Examiner trap 10: Do not turn a vacancy-saving clause into a textual largest-opposition-party substitution.

MCQ 11. Tenure

The ordinary tenure rule for the Chairperson or a Member is:

A. Five years without an age ceiling. B. Six years or age sixty-five, whichever is earlier. C. Five years or age seventy, whichever is earlier. D. Four years or age seventy, whichever is earlier.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Five years without an age ceiling.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 6 fixes five years from entering office or attainment of age 70, whichever occurs earlier.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Six years or age sixty-five, whichever is earlier.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 6 fixes five years from entering office or attainment of age 70, whichever occurs earlier.
- **C:** Correct. Section 6 fixes five years from entering office or attainment of age 70, whichever occurs earlier.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Four years or age seventy, whichever is earlier.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 6 fixes five years from entering office or attainment of age 70, whichever occurs earlier.

Examiner trap 11: Lokpal tenure must not be borrowed from the CVC, CIC or Election Commission.

MCQ 12. Post-tenure restriction

Which post-tenure proposition is correct?

A. Every Member may be reappointed for another full five-year term. B. A former Member may accept any Union office of profit. C. A former Chairperson may immediately contest a parliamentary election. D. A Member may become Chairperson only if aggregate Lokpal tenure does not exceed five years.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Every Member may be reappointed for another full five-year term.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 8 bars ordinary reappointment and specified assignments/employment/elections, while allowing Member-to-Chairperson elevation within a five-year aggregate.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A former Member may accept any Union office of profit.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 8 bars ordinary reappointment and specified assignments/employment/elections, while allowing Member-to-Chairperson elevation within a five-year aggregate.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A former Chairperson may immediately contest a parliamentary election.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 8 bars ordinary reappointment and specified assignments/employment/elections, while allowing Member-to-Chairperson elevation within a five-year aggregate.
- **D:** Correct. Section 8 bars ordinary reappointment and specified assignments/employment/elections, while allowing Member-to-Chairperson elevation within a five-year aggregate.

Examiner trap 12: The Member-to-Chairperson exception does not restart the tenure clock.

MCQ 13. Removal route

Removal for misbehaviour ordinarily requires:

A. A petition signed by at least one hundred MPs, Presidential reference and Supreme Court inquiry. B. A Cabinet resolution followed by departmental inquiry. C. An internal Lokpal inquiry and majority vote. D. A simple-majority resolution of the Lok Sabha.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Section 37 places proved misbehaviour on a petition-reference-Supreme Court inquiry route and bars Lokpal from inquiring into its own Chairperson or Member.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A Cabinet resolution followed by departmental inquiry.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 37 places proved misbehaviour on a petition-reference-Supreme Court inquiry route and bars Lokpal from inquiring into its own Chairperson or Member.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'An internal Lokpal inquiry and majority vote.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 37 places proved misbehaviour on a petition-reference-Supreme Court inquiry route and bars Lokpal from inquiring into its own Chairperson or Member.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'A simple-majority resolution of the Lok Sabha.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 37 places proved misbehaviour on a petition-reference-Supreme Court inquiry route and bars Lokpal from inquiring into its own Chairperson or Member.

Examiner trap 13: Use section 37's own threshold; do not import impeachment or CVC formulas.

MCQ 14. Direct removal ground

Which is a direct presidential removal ground under section 37(4)?

A. An adverse newspaper editorial. B. Being adjudged insolvent. C. Dissent from a majority decision of Lokpal. D. Policy disagreement with the Union Government.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'An adverse newspaper editorial.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Insolvency is listed, along with paid outside employment during tenure and qualifying infirmity of mind or body.
- **B:** Correct. Insolvency is listed, along with paid outside employment during tenure and qualifying infirmity of mind or body.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Dissent from a majority decision of Lokpal.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Insolvency is listed, along with paid outside employment during tenure and qualifying infirmity of mind or body.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Policy disagreement with the Union Government.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Insolvency is listed, along with paid outside employment during tenure and qualifying infirmity of mind or body.

Examiner trap 14: Direct grounds are narrow statutory facts, not political dissatisfaction.

MCQ 15. Prime Minister screen

A complaint concerning the Prime Minister may proceed only if, among other conditions:

A. The CVC unanimously approves. B. Each House of Parliament first passes a resolution. C. The full Lokpal bench considers initiation and at least two-thirds of its Members approve. D. The Chief Justice of India conducts the preliminary inquiry.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'The CVC unanimously approves.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 14 requires full-bench consideration and approval by at least two-thirds, in addition to subject exclusions and in-camera treatment.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Each House of Parliament first passes a resolution.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 14 requires full-bench consideration and approval by at least two-thirds, in addition to subject exclusions and in-camera treatment.
- **C:** Correct. Section 14 requires full-bench consideration and approval by at least two-thirds, in addition to subject exclusions and in-camera treatment.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'The Chief Justice of India conducts the preliminary inquiry.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 14 requires full-bench consideration and approval by at least two-thirds, in addition to subject exclusions and in-camera treatment.

Examiner trap 15: PM coverage is neither ordinary identical treatment nor complete immunity.

MCQ 16. PM confidentiality

If a complaint against the Prime Minister is dismissed after the special inquiry:

A. It must be tabled immediately in Parliament. B. Only the complainant may publish the record. C. It must be published after thirty days. D. The inquiry records shall not be published or made available to anyone.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It must be tabled immediately in Parliament.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The second proviso to section 14(1)(a) creates this specific non-publication rule for a dismissed PM inquiry.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Only the complainant may publish the record.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The second proviso to section 14(1)(a) creates this specific non-publication rule for a dismissed PM inquiry.

- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'It must be published after thirty days.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The second proviso to section 14(1)(a) creates this specific non-publication rule for a dismissed PM inquiry.
- **D:** Correct. The second proviso to section 14(1)(a) creates this specific non-publication rule for a dismissed PM inquiry.

Examiner trap 16: Do not generalise the PM-specific secrecy rule to every Lokpal proceeding.

MCQ 17. Privilege after Sita Soren

Which proposition correctly reconciles section 14(2) with Sita Soren (2024)?

A. Genuine parliamentary speech or vote remains protected, but bribery connected with it is not immunised. B. Members of Parliament are wholly outside Lokpal jurisdiction. C. Every parliamentary speech may be treated as corruption evidence without constitutional limit. D. Article 105(2) was judicially repealed.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Sita Soren held that bribery is not protected by Articles 105(2) or 194(2), while the constitutional immunity for the legislative act itself remains.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Members of Parliament are wholly outside Lokpal jurisdiction.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Sita Soren held that bribery is not protected by Articles 105(2) or 194(2), while the constitutional immunity for the legislative act itself remains.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Every parliamentary speech may be treated as corruption evidence without constitutional limit.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Sita Soren held that bribery is not protected by Articles 105(2) or 194(2), while the constitutional immunity for the legislative act itself remains.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Article 105(2) was judicially repealed.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Sita Soren held that bribery is not protected by Articles 105(2) or 194(2), while the constitutional immunity for the legislative act itself remains.

Examiner trap 17: Separate the protected speech/vote from the independently complete offence of bribery.

MCQ 18. CVC routing

Where Lokpal chooses preliminary inquiry for Groups A-D Union officials:

A. Departments conduct the final criminal trial. B. CVC reports on Groups A/B to Lokpal and proceeds under the CVC Act for Groups C/D. C. CBI decides whether Lokpal has jurisdiction. D. Every category goes directly to the Special Court.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Departments conduct the final criminal trial.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The first two provisos to section 20(1) create a split CVC route: A/B reporting to Lokpal and C/D processing under the CVC Act.
- **B:** Correct. The first two provisos to section 20(1) create a split CVC route: A/B reporting to Lokpal and C/D processing under the CVC Act.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'CBI decides whether Lokpal has jurisdiction.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The first two provisos to section 20(1) create a split CVC route: A/B reporting to Lokpal and C/D processing under the CVC Act.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Every category goes directly to the Special Court.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The first two provisos to section 20(1) create a split CVC route: A/B reporting to Lokpal and C/D processing under the CVC Act.

Examiner trap 18: The route changes by service group and by stage; CVC does not become the trial court.

MCQ 19. Foreign-funded entity boundary

Section 14(1)(h) reaches specified officers of a society, association or trust receiving:

A. Only grants from the United Nations. B. Any domestic donation of any amount. C. Foreign-source donation exceeding ten lakh rupees in a year, or a higher amount notified by the Central Government. D. Any government grant without the separate statutory conditions.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Only grants from the United Nations.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Clause (h) uses a foreign-source donation threshold above Rs 10 lakh in a year, subject to any higher amount formally notified.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Any domestic donation of any amount.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Clause (h) uses a foreign-source donation threshold above Rs 10 lakh in a year, subject to any higher amount formally notified.
- **C:** Correct. Clause (h) uses a foreign-source donation threshold above Rs 10 lakh in a year, subject to any higher amount formally notified.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Any government grant without the separate statutory conditions.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Clause (h) uses a foreign-source donation threshold above Rs 10 lakh in a year, subject to any higher amount formally notified.

Examiner trap 19: Do not confuse clause (h)'s express foreign threshold with clause (g)'s notified income condition.

MCQ 20. Former officeholders

Former public servants under section 14:

A. Become immune on retirement. B. Remain covered for every private act throughout life. C. Are covered only if re-employed by government. D. May be covered for alleged conduct during the period in which they served in the relevant statutory capacity.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Become immune on retirement.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 14 repeatedly uses 'is or has been', while its explanation ties the complaint to the period of covered public service.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Remain covered for every private act throughout life.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 14 repeatedly uses 'is or has been', while its explanation ties the complaint to the period of covered public service.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Are covered only if re-employed by government.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 14 repeatedly uses 'is or has been', while its explanation ties the complaint to the period of covered public service.
- **D:** Correct. Section 14 repeatedly uses 'is or has been', while its explanation ties the complaint to the period of covered public service.

Examiner trap 20: Post-tenure coverage follows the time of conduct, not a general lifelong public-servant label.

MCQ 21. Complaint Rules

Which filing requirement is consistent with the Lokpal (Complaint) Rules, 2020?

A. A prescribed form accompanied by identity material, a signed allegation and the required affidavit/annexures. B. Anonymous oral information with no prescribed particulars. C. Prior consent of the accused public servant. D. Mandatory filing only through an advocate.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. The 2020 Rules structure complaints through Form I, filing modes, identity and supporting documents, and an affidavit.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Anonymous oral information with no prescribed particulars.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The 2020 Rules structure complaints through Form I, filing modes, identity and supporting documents, and an affidavit.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Prior consent of the accused public servant.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The 2020 Rules structure complaints through Form I, filing modes, identity and supporting documents, and an affidavit.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Mandatory filing only through an advocate.' conflicts with the controlling rule: The 2020 Rules structure complaints through Form I, filing modes, identity and supporting documents, and an affidavit.

Examiner trap 21: Complaint formalities regulate access; they do not predetermine truth or guilt.

MCQ 22. Inquiry versus investigation

The best distinction between preliminary inquiry and investigation is:

A. Preliminary inquiry is always conducted by a court. B. Preliminary inquiry tests prima facie basis; investigation gathers evidence for the criminal report. C. Investigation is only a departmental proceeding. D. Both are final adjudicatory trials.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Preliminary inquiry is always conducted by a court.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Sections 2 and 20 assign a screening function to preliminary inquiry and an evidence-gathering criminal-process function to investigation.
- **B:** Correct. Sections 2 and 20 assign a screening function to preliminary inquiry and an evidence-gathering criminal-process function to investigation.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Investigation is only a departmental proceeding.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Sections 2 and 20 assign a screening function to preliminary inquiry and an evidence-gathering criminal-process function to investigation.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Both are final adjudicatory trials.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Sections 2 and 20 assign a screening function to preliminary inquiry and an evidence-gathering criminal-process function to investigation.

Examiner trap 22: Do not use 'inquiry', 'investigation' and 'trial' as interchangeable words.

MCQ 23. Preliminary-inquiry timing

Which timeline combination is correct under section 20?

A. The preliminary report is due in ninety days and investigation can never be extended. B. Every inquiry and trial must finish within six months. C. The report is due within sixty days of reference; preliminary inquiry is ordinarily ninety days with a further ninety days for recorded reasons. D. Preliminary inquiry always ends in thirty days and investigation in ninety days.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'The preliminary report is due in ninety days and investigation can never be extended.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(2) supplies the 60-day report rule and section 20(4) the ordinary 90-day plus further 90-day framework.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Every inquiry and trial must finish within six months.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(2) supplies the 60-day report rule and section 20(4) the ordinary 90-day plus further 90-day framework.
- **C:** Correct. Section 20(2) supplies the 60-day report rule and section 20(4) the ordinary 90-day plus further 90-day framework.

- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Preliminary inquiry always ends in thirty days and investigation in ninety days.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(2) supplies the 60-day report rule and section 20(4) the ordinary 90-day plus further 90-day framework.

Examiner trap 23: The report deadline and overall preliminary-inquiry period are distinct clocks.

MCQ 24. Post-inquiry decision

After considering a preliminary-inquiry report, a bench of at least three Lokpal Members may:

A. Amend the Prevention of Corruption Act. B. Convict the public servant. C. Dissolve the concerned department. D. Order investigation, direct departmental or other action, or close proceedings under statutory conditions.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Amend the Prevention of Corruption Act.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(3) specifies investigation, departmental/other action, or closure; legislative amendment and conviction are outside the bench's role.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Convict the public servant.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(3) specifies investigation, departmental/other action, or closure; legislative amendment and conviction are outside the bench's role.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Dissolve the concerned department.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(3) specifies investigation, departmental/other action, or closure; legislative amendment and conviction are outside the bench's role.
- **D:** Correct. Section 20(3) specifies investigation, departmental/other action, or closure; legislative amendment and conviction are outside the bench's role.

Examiner trap 24: A prima facie decision is a routing decision, not a criminal verdict.

MCQ 25. Investigation timing

An investigation directed by Lokpal should ordinarily be completed within:

A. Six months, with reasoned extensions not exceeding six months at a time. B. Seven years. C. Thirty days without extension. D. One year without extension.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Section 20(5) sets six months from the order and permits further periods not exceeding six months at a time for written reasons.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Seven years.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(5) sets six months from the order and permits further periods not exceeding six months at a time for written reasons.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Thirty days without extension.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(5) sets six months from the order and permits further periods not exceeding six months at a time for written reasons.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'One year without extension.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 20(5) sets six months from the order and permits further periods not exceeding six months at a time for written reasons.

Examiner trap 25: The seven-year number is the complaint limitation, not the investigation period.

MCQ 26. DSPE superintendence

Lokpal's superintendence over the DSPE:

A. Eliminates every State-consent requirement. B. Applies to Lokpal-referred matters but cannot dictate investigation or disposal in a particular manner. C. Extends automatically to every CBI case in India. D. Makes Lokpal the administrative Director of CBI.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Eliminates every State-consent requirement.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 25 is expressly confined to matters referred under the Act and contains an anti-dictation proviso.
- **B:** Correct. Section 25 is expressly confined to matters referred under the Act and contains an anti-dictation proviso.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Extends automatically to every CBI case in India.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 25 is expressly confined to matters referred under the Act and contains an anti-dictation proviso.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Makes Lokpal the administrative Director of CBI.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 25 is expressly confined to matters referred under the Act and contains an anti-dictation proviso.

Examiner trap 26: Superintendence is neither nationwide ownership of CBI nor power to command a predetermined result.

MCQ 27. Investigator transfer

A DSPE officer investigating a Lokpal-referred case:

A. Is appointed by the complainant. B. Can never be transferred under any circumstance. C. Cannot be transferred without Lokpal approval. D. May be transferred only by a resolution of Parliament.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Is appointed by the complainant.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 25(3) requires Lokpal approval for transfer of the officer investigating its referred case.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Can never be transferred under any circumstance.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 25(3) requires Lokpal approval for transfer of the officer investigating its referred case.
- **C:** Correct. Section 25(3) requires Lokpal approval for transfer of the officer investigating its referred case.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'May be transferred only by a resolution of Parliament.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 25(3) requires Lokpal approval for transfer of the officer investigating its referred case.

Examiner trap 27: The safeguard is case-specific and is not an absolute lifetime transfer ban.

MCQ 28. Search power

Under section 26:

A. Search is barred before completion of trial. B. Lokpal Members personally conduct every physical search. C. CVC issues every search warrant in a Lokpal matter. D. Lokpal may authorise the agency entrusted with investigation to search for and seize relevant secreted documents.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Search is barred before completion of trial.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 26 is an authorisation power exercised through the entrusted investigating agency, subject to statutory conditions.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Lokpal Members personally conduct every physical search.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 26 is an authorisation power exercised through the entrusted investigating agency, subject to statutory conditions.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'CVC issues every search warrant in a Lokpal matter.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 26 is an authorisation power exercised through the entrusted investigating agency, subject to

statutory conditions.

- **D:** Correct. Section 26 is an authorisation power exercised through the entrusted investigating agency, subject to statutory conditions.

Examiner trap 28: A power to authorise search does not convert Lokpal into a police force.

MCQ 29. Civil-court powers

The Inquiry Wing's specified civil-court powers include:

A. Summoning persons and requiring production of documents during preliminary inquiry. B. Declaring Acts of Parliament unconstitutional. C. Exercising a general contempt jurisdiction. D. Awarding criminal sentences.

Answer: A.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Correct. Section 27 confers enumerated evidence-gathering powers such as summons and document production for preliminary inquiry.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Declaring Acts of Parliament unconstitutional.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 27 confers enumerated evidence-gathering powers such as summons and document production for preliminary inquiry.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Exercising a general contempt jurisdiction.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 27 confers enumerated evidence-gathering powers such as summons and document production for preliminary inquiry.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Awarding criminal sentences.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 27 confers enumerated evidence-gathering powers such as summons and document production for preliminary inquiry.

Examiner trap 29: Limited civil-court powers do not create a court of plenary jurisdiction.

MCQ 30. Provisional attachment

Provisional attachment under section 29 may ordinarily last:

A. Indefinitely at Lokpal's discretion. B. Up to ninety days, with the order and material immediately placed before the Special Court. C. Until the public servant retires. D. Thirty days without judicial involvement.

Answer: B.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Indefinitely at Lokpal's discretion.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 29 caps the initial attachment at 90 days and requires immediate sealed transmission to the Special Court; section 30 adds a 30-day confirmation application.
- **B:** Correct. Section 29 caps the initial attachment at 90 days and requires immediate sealed transmission to the Special Court; section 30 adds a 30-day confirmation application.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Until the public servant retires.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 29 caps the initial attachment at 90 days and requires immediate sealed transmission to the Special Court; section 30 adds a 30-day confirmation application.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Thirty days without judicial involvement.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 29 caps the initial attachment at 90 days and requires immediate sealed transmission to the Special Court; section 30 adds a 30-day confirmation application.

Examiner trap 30: Keep the 90-day attachment period separate from the 30-day application deadline.

MCQ 31. Prosecution sanction

Lokpal's prosecution-sanction power:

A. Applies without qualification to every constitutional office-holder. B. Replaces the Special Court's trial jurisdiction. C. Authorises prosecution in the section 20 route, subject to section 23's constitutional-office qualification. D. Is legally identical to conviction.

Answer: C.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Applies without qualification to every constitutional office-holder.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 23 overrides specified ordinary sanction provisions for the section 20(7)(a) route but preserves offices with constitutionally specified removal procedures.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Replaces the Special Court's trial jurisdiction.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 23 overrides specified ordinary sanction provisions for the section 20(7)(a) route but preserves offices with constitutionally specified removal procedures.
- **C:** Correct. Section 23 overrides specified ordinary sanction provisions for the section 20(7)(a) route but preserves offices with constitutionally specified removal procedures.
- **D:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Is legally identical to conviction.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 23 overrides specified ordinary sanction provisions for the section 20(7)(a) route but preserves offices with constitutionally specified removal procedures.

Examiner trap 31: Sanction permits prosecution; it does not establish the offence.

MCQ 32. Special Court timing

The Special Court is expected to complete a trial:

A. Within six months with no extension. B. Within three months in every case. C. Whenever Lokpal directs, without a statutory target. D. Within one year, with recorded three-month extensions but a total period not exceeding two years.

Answer: D.

Option-specific explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Within six months with no extension.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 35 sets a one-year target and permits reasoned extensions of not more than three months each, subject to a two-year total ceiling.
- **B:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Within three months in every case.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 35 sets a one-year target and permits reasoned extensions of not more than three months each, subject to a two-year total ceiling.
- **C:** Incorrect. The proposition 'Whenever Lokpal directs, without a statutory target.' conflicts with the controlling rule: Section 35 sets a one-year target and permits reasoned extensions of not more than three months each, subject to a two-year total ceiling.
- **D:** Correct. Section 35 sets a one-year target and permits reasoned extensions of not more than three months each, subject to a two-year total ceiling.

Examiner trap 32: The three-month figure is an extension unit, not the ordinary trial period.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified direct Prelims PYQ - Civil Services Preliminary Examination 2025, GS Paper I, Set A, Question 98

Consider the following statements about Lokpal: I. The power of Lokpal applies to public servants of India, but not to the Indian public servants posted outside India. II. The Chairperson or a Member shall not be a Member of the Parliament or a Member of the Legislature of any State or Union Territory, and only the Chief Justice of India, whether incumbent or retired, has to be its Chairperson. III. The Chairperson or a Member shall not be a person of less than forty-five years of age on the date of assuming office as the Chairperson or Member, as the case may be. IV. Lokpal cannot inquire into the allegations of corruption against a sitting Prime Minister of India. Which of the statements given above is/are correct? (a) III only (b) II and III (c) I and IV (d) None of the above statements is correct

Official Set-A key: A - III only. The local official UPSC paper and answer-key PDF were checked directly.

Statement	Verdict	Statutory reason
I	False	Section 1(3) applies the Act to public servants in and outside India.
II	False as a compound statement	The office-holding disqualification is correct, but section 3 does not restrict the Chairperson to only the CJI.
III	True	Section 3(4)(iii) fixes the minimum age at 45.
IV	False	Section 14 includes a serving Prime Minister subject to special exclusions and procedure.

PYQ trap: A compound statement fails if one limb is false; statement II uses a true disqualification to conceal a false exclusivity claim.

Original solved Mains practice

The following six questions are original practice, not UPSC PYQs. The models are deliberately capped at the stated limits.

Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: "Lokpal is an ombudsman, not a corruption court." Explain.

Demand: Answer the exact directive, use statutory/case evidence, explain what it proves, and finish with a qualified verdict.

Model answer

The Lokpal is a statutory Union anti-corruption ombudsman under the 2013 Act. Its authority is significant but process-oriented.

Claim: Lokpal can move a complaint toward accountability. **Named evidence:** sections 20, 23, 25 and 29 permit inquiry or investigation routing, prosecution sanction, supervision of referred DSPE matters and provisional attachment. **Analysis:** these powers make it more than a merely recommendatory grievance office. **Qualification:** each power is bounded by statute, hearing requirements and court control.

Claim: Criminal guilt remains judicial. **Named evidence:** sections 30-31 place attachment/confiscation under the Special Court, while section 35 assigns trial to Special Courts. **Analysis:** preliminary inquiry tests a prima facie case, investigation gathers evidence and prosecution presents it. **Qualification:** none equals conviction.

Therefore, Lokpal is a powerful institutional gateway and coordinator, but the Special Court alone may convict and sentence.

Audited model length: 134 words (ceiling: 150).

Why this earns marks: It uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification and directly answers the directive without treating allegations, sanction or prosecution as guilt.

Mains 2 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Explain the special statutory safeguards governing a corruption complaint against the Prime Minister.

Demand: Answer the exact directive, use statutory/case evidence, explain what it proves, and finish with a qualified verdict.

Model answer

Section 14 includes a serving or former Prime Minister, but uses exceptional filters.

Claim: Sensitive sovereign functions receive a subject-matter shield. **Named evidence:** allegations relating to international relations, external or internal security, public order, atomic energy and space are excluded. **Analysis:** the exclusion protects core State interests. **Qualification:** it is not blanket personal immunity.

Claim: initiation carries a high institutional threshold. **Named evidence:** the full Lokpal bench must consider the matter and at least two-thirds of its Members must approve. The inquiry is in camera; if dismissed, its records cannot be published or made available. **Analysis:** these rules deter partisan fishing and protect confidentiality. **Qualification:** secrecy can reduce public visibility and therefore requires scrupulous internal reason-giving.

Thus, the Act balances Prime Ministerial accountability with stability and sensitive-information safeguards.

Audited model length: 128 words (ceiling: 150).

Why this earns marks: It uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification and directly answers the directive without treating allegations, sanction or prosecution as guilt.

Mains 3 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Analyse the Lokpal-CVC-CBI relationship. Why is it misleading to describe it as a simple hierarchy?

Demand: Answer the exact directive, use statutory/case evidence, explain what it proves, and finish with a qualified verdict.

Model answer

The three bodies share an anti-corruption objective but possess different legal identities and stage-specific powers.

Claim: Lokpal controls entry and statutory routing. **Named evidence:** section 20 allows preliminary inquiry or investigation and sends specified Groups A-D preliminary-inquiry matters to the CVC. **Analysis:** for Groups A/B the report returns to Lokpal; Groups C/D continue under the CVC Act. **Qualification:** CVC retains its independent vigilance statute.

Claim: CBI/DSPE supplies criminal-investigation capacity. **Named evidence:** sections 20 and 25 permit referral to DSPE and give Lokpal superintendence over referred matters. **Analysis:** transfer approval for the investigating officer protects continuity. **Qualification:** the anti-dictation proviso bars an order to investigate or dispose of a case in a predetermined manner, and non-referred CBI work is outside this control.

Claim: prosecution and judgment remain separate. **Named evidence:** sections 12, 23 and 35 allocate prosecution to the Prosecution Wing/agency and adjudication to Special Courts. **Analysis:** separation reduces concentration of coercive power. **Qualification:** fragmentation may cause delay.

Hence the system is a network of allocated functions, requiring coordination without legal conflation.

Audited model length: 175 words (ceiling: 250).

Why this earns marks: It uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification and directly answers the directive without treating allegations, sanction or prosecution as guilt.

Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Evaluate whether Lokpal's appointment, tenure and removal design adequately protects independence.

Demand: Answer the exact directive, use statutory/case evidence, explain what it proves, and finish with a qualified verdict.

Model answer

Lokpal's design contains substantial safeguards, though institutional independence ultimately depends on timely and credible implementation.

Claim: appointment is plural. **Named evidence:** section 4 combines the Prime Minister, Lok Sabha Speaker, Leader of Opposition, CJI or nominee and an eminent jurist, assisted by a diverse Search Committee. **Analysis:** multiple constitutional locations reduce unilateral appointment. **Qualification:** the executive remains influential, and the Selection Committee may look beyond the search panel.

Claim: tenure reduces renewal pressure. **Named evidence:** section 6 fixes five years or age seventy; section 8 bars ordinary reappointment and specified post-tenure offices and elections. **Analysis:** this weakens incentives to please the appointing government. **Qualification:** a Member may become Chairperson within an aggregate five-year ceiling.

Claim: removal is protected. **Named evidence:** section 37 requires a petition of at least 100 MPs, Presidential reference and Supreme Court inquiry for misbehaviour. **Analysis:** ordinary executive displeasure cannot remove a Member. **Qualification:** insolvency, paid outside employment and qualifying infirmity permit direct presidential removal.

Common Cause (2017) prevented vacancy from becoming an implementation veto. Yet delays and unfilled capacity can defeat formal autonomy. Independence therefore requires transparent appointments, stable staff and reasoned reporting alongside legal safeguards.

Audited model length: 190 words (ceiling: 250).

Why this earns marks: It uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification and directly answers the directive without treating allegations, sanction or prosecution as guilt.

Mains 5 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: "The Lokpal Act is broad in jurisdiction but filtered in operation." Critically analyse.

Demand: Answer the exact directive, use statutory/case evidence, explain what it proves, and finish with a qualified verdict.

Model answer

The Act creates broad personal reach but channels it through offence, subject, procedure and institutional filters.

Claim: jurisdiction spans high and ordinary public office. **Named evidence:** section 14 covers the Prime Minister, Union Ministers, MPs, Groups A-D officials, former functionaries and specified officers of government-linked or foreign-funded entities. **Analysis:** accountability follows public function and qualifying institutional links. **Qualification:** it is not general jurisdiction over every private person; clause-specific thresholds and State consent may apply.

Claim: high office is specially protected, not wholly immune. **Named evidence:** PM matters face five excluded domains, full-bench consideration, two-thirds approval and in-camera inquiry. MPs retain Article 105(2) protection for genuine speech/vote. **Analysis:** these filters preserve constitutional functioning. **Qualification:** Sita Soren (2024) confirms bribery itself is not privileged.

Claim: operation is procedurally screened. **Named evidence:** Complaint Rules 2020, section 20 hearings and timelines, section 53's seven-year bar, and section 46's good-faith safeguard. **Analysis:** screening protects reputation and fair process. **Qualification:** excessive formalism can chill access.

The statute is therefore neither toothless nor omnipotent: broad reach becomes effective only through sound capacity, independent investigation and transparent, reviewable procedure.

Audited model length: 183 words (ceiling: 250).

Why this earns marks: It uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification and directly answers the directive without treating allegations, sanction or prosecution as guilt.

Mains 6 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: Assess the strengths and weaknesses of the Lokpal-Lokayukta framework and suggest reforms consistent with federalism and due process.

Demand: Answer the exact directive, use statutory/case evidence, explain what it proves, and finish with a qualified verdict.

Model answer

The framework's principal strength is an integrated statutory route from complaint to court without formally merging all powers.

Claim: Lokpal has credible legal tools. **Named evidence:** sections 20, 23, 25 and 29-35 provide inquiry/investigation routing, sanction, referred-case DSPE safeguards, attachment and Special Courts. **Analysis:** high-office coverage and court-linked enforcement exceed a purely advisory ombudsman. **Qualification:** Lokpal lacks a general express suo-motu route and depends on external investigators.

Claim: independence is institutionally supported. **Named evidence:** plural selection, fixed tenure, section 37 removal protection, charged expenditure, CAG audit and section 48 reporting. **Analysis:** these distribute control and create accountability. **Qualification:** vacancies, staff shortages, procedural delay and opaque disposal can hollow out formal guarantees.

Claim: State flexibility is constitutionally practical. **Named evidence:** section 63 requires each State to legislate but prescribes no uniform composition or power. Maharashtra and Karnataka illustrate different statutory models.

Analysis: experimentation is possible. **Qualification:** citizens receive uneven protection.

Reform should ensure timely appointments, stable multidisciplinary staff, interoperable Lokpal-CVC-CBI tracking, anonymised stage-wise disclosure, current asset-declaration rules and a model minimum Lokayukta framework. Any new suo-motu or investigative power should carry recorded reasons, recusal, hearing and judicial review.

Audited model length: 188 words (ceiling: 250).

Why this earns marks: It uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification and directly answers the directive without treating allegations, sanction or prosecution as guilt.